Oh the Growing Pains (They're Keeping me up Again)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56926801.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Abusive Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Catra Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Child Abuse, Pre-Canon, Sickfic, Whump, Angst

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by unicorn_sparkles2006

Summary

One morning a child Adora wakes up sick… she isn’t the only one who receives the punishment from it.

title from growing pains by Lexie Carroll

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Adora awoke to her head pounding. It was quite a horrible thing. She felt cold as sweat rolled down her small body and every inch of her shook. She let out a small cough, gasping for air as if her lungs were filled with liquid. That cough however, turned into a fit, causing her to shoot up.

She felt Catra startle at her feet, and she could tell that she was staring at her- just a spluttering mess.

"'Dora?" The young cat girl rubbed sleep out of her eyes as Adora's coughing fit died down, "What's wrong?"

"Nothing," Adora rasped. "I'm ok, just go back to bed."

Catra frowned, not believing her, "You're burning up." She removed her fur covered hand away from Adora's forehead. "That is not good."

The two girls sat there in silence. Adora's raspy breathing filling the air.

"What are we going to do?" Catra finally said.

"What do you mean?" Adora's face pinched, "I'm going to suck it up and go to training- that's what everyone has to do."

"I think you're really sick, 'Dora, maybe we should tell Shadow Weaver."

Adora shook her head frantically, "No, we can't. You know what the Horde does to sick soldiers."

"But we're just kids!" Catra argued, "Remember when Lonnie caught the flu last year? She missed training and spent a week in the medbay,"

"That's Lonnie," Adora sighed. "You know Shadow Weaver has different expectations for us."

“Right,” Catra scowled. “We can’t let our future force captain take a sick day.”

”Catra please-“ Adora’s eyes drooped, “I’m so tired. My head hurts so bad, and it feels like my lungs are full of water.”

Catra’s anger was quickly replaced with worry, “You can’t go to training today, Adora. Something’s really wrong.”

She was cut off by the morning alarms ringing and the barrack lights turning on.

“It’s not like I have much of a choice.”

Training felt like actual hell. They were fighting with partners and today Adora was paired with Lonnie. She was usually paired with Catra, who would definitely go easy on her today, but Shadow Weaver had chosen to separate the two. Something about Catra being a distraction, Adora really couldn’t remember.

It was like she couldn’t see straight. She could feel the pounding of her head through her whole body and she couldn’t suck in a whole breath of air. Lonnie was beating her, bad. But it wasn’t Adora’s fault she was seeing double, or that her body was moving so slowly.

Finally, Lonnie knocked Adora off of her feet, her head hitting the ground with a small crack. If her head didn’t hurt before, it definitely hurt now.

All Adora could hear was the ringing of her own ears. Lonnie hovered over her with an odd look on her face, like a mixture of triumph and worry.

Everything moved in blurs and bits, and the last thing Adora saw as she was carried out of the room was the scoreboard. Her name was 4th, right after Rogelio and before Kyle. She knew that she was going to be in a lot of trouble.

Adora wasn't sure how long she spent in the medbay. Various nurses hovered over her, checking her head and listening to her lungs. Each of her breaths came out with a wheeze and she felt herself floating farther and farther away. A few pricks and pokes later she finally did.

She woke up with a start to Shadow Weaver hovering over her, furious. Noticing that Adora was awake, she ripped the iv out of the girls arm and grabbed her, dragging her out of the room.

Adora only felt horror as Shadow Weaver led her to the Black Garnet Chamber. Her heart thudded in her chest and she shook- though she was not sure if it was due to her fear or the sickness.

They finally reached their destination as Shadow Weaver crouched down to Adora's level, the black garnet hissing behind her.

"You came in fourth today, Adora."

"I was sick," Adora's voice shook. "They took me to the medbay and everything!"

"Force captains do not get sick, Adora," Shadow Weaver shook her head as red lightning became closer and closer to her. "What were you thinking? Letting scoring fourth and letting Catra get first?"

Adora shook with fear as she had nothing to say, only upsetting Shadow Weaver more.

"I know I should have never taken that mangy animal in, all she has ever done is distract you. Maybe I need to dispose of her myself."

Adora's eyes shot open, "No! Shadow Weaver please!" She begged, "It won't happen again, I'll score better."

"Oh, Adora," Shadow Weaver hummed, red lightning fully incasing the both of them. "Look at what she has done to you."

”It’s not Catra’s fault,” Adora wined, tears falling down her cheeks. “I’ll do better, I promise.”

The lightning went away as there was a soft knock on the door. “I’m afraid that your promises are to late, child.”

Adora could do nothing to stop Catra from entering the room. She could not fight the red lightning incasing her, holding her in place. And she could only scream and cry as she watched Catra’s torment.

End Notes

so, that was my first attempt at a one shot. i hop you guys liked it- it was just a small drabble floating around in my head

never be afraid to comment thoughts or any constructive criticism, it is all appreciated.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!